

By integrating satellite monitoring, artificial intelligence and field data, the company ensures transparent and verifiable carbon removal. For instance, Varaha trains farmers to convert crop waste into biochar using low-emission kilns, preventing carbon release. It supports on-ground implementation and ensures optimal biochar use. Varaha verifies carbon removal using satellite data and digital tools and helps farmers earn carbon credits. Madhur Jain, co-founder and Chief Executive Officer, says the company has demonstrated how deep-tech innovation, supportive policies and market-driven models can converge to create scalable climate solutions.

Jain is not in the business of climate tech for altruism. He says profitability and sustainability must go hand-in-hand and climate action can be both economically viable and environmentally transformative. With \$8.7 million in Series A funding, Varaha is leading the charge in making carbon removal from agriculture a reality. Its ambition is to sequester one billion tonnes of carbon dioxide emissions from smallholder lands.

The Gurugram, Haryana-based company is named after an incarnation of Lord Vishnu who, according to mythological accounts, saved the Earth by lifting it out of the ocean and placing it back in its place in the universe. Varaha, which claims to be the only climate-change tech startup focused on developing economies, and other deep-tech start-ups are trying to do something similar.

They have stepped up to the plate to help countries in the effort to meet their target of net-zero carbon emissions — a goal that will be achieved when greenhouse gas emissions and their removal are in balance.

HARDCORE SCIENCE

From carbon capture to energy storage and agritech, these ventures are less about sustainability slogans and more about hardcore science. Climate tech, once a niche,

is now a revolution powered by tech that just happens to fight climate change.

Most of the money raised by climate-change tech companies, however, has been limited to

Sector	Number of deals	Total funding in June-Aug 2024 (\$mn)	Total funding in July-Sept 2024 (\$mn)
• Mobility	16	182	220
• Waste management & circular economy	11	18	90
• Energy	3	7	6
• Environment and natural resources	3	1	8
• Climate-smart agriculture & food	1	19	3
• Others	0	12	0

SOURCE INDIA CLIMATE BULLETIN
NOTE THE DATA IS FOR FIRST HALF OF FY24-25

THE NEED FOR PUSH



- ▶ Only one out of four (approximately 220) has raised capital
- ▶ More than two-third of all funded start-ups have raised only a seed round
- ▶ The total funding was only about \$3.6 bn; fintechs in India raised \$19.3 bn (~six times over)

- ▶ Out of the 2,600 registered climate tech start-ups, about 800 are operational
- ▶ Only 20 start-ups have raised growth-stage funding (Series A+)